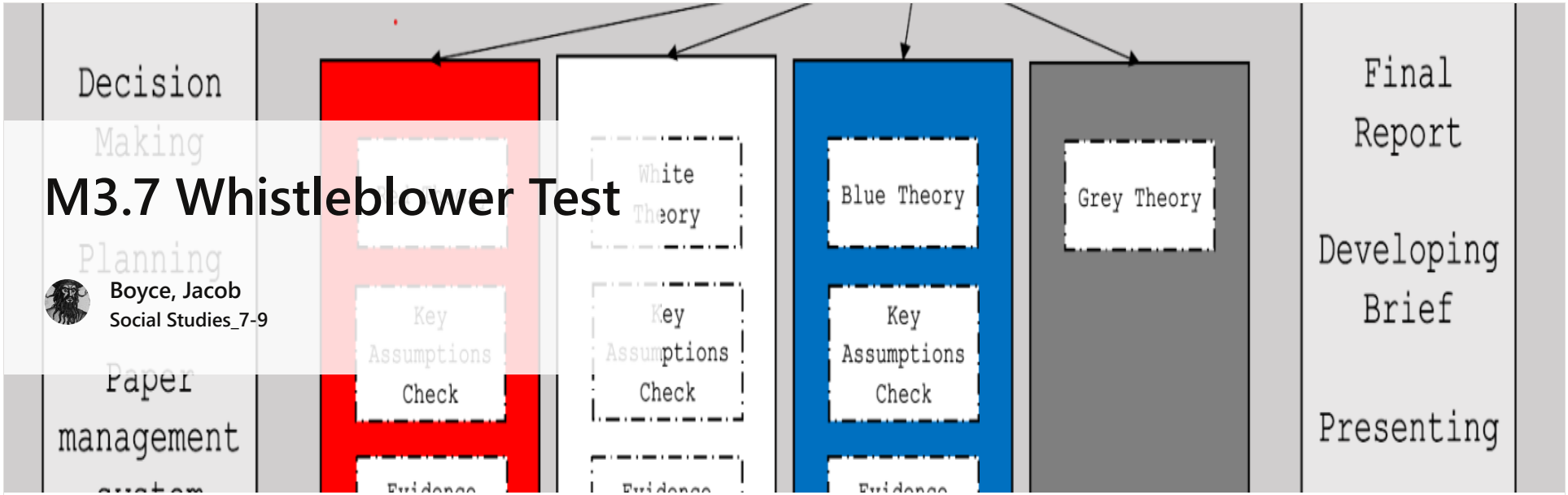


M3.7 Whistleblower Test

Boyce, Jacob
Social Studies_7-9

Whistle Blower Test

The Whistle Blower test is a consideration of the odds that your hypothesis would be exposed by someone who is supposed to have kept it secret. This may seem fundamentally flawed because we only have the one side of the data to work with, meaning we cannot account for conspiracies that have never been found out or that had been exposed in ways other than whistle blowers. However, we can look at the pattern of whistle blowing and apply that pattern to your hypothesis with a reasonable estimation that the odds of whistleblowing is consistent in consistent circumstances.

Historical Case Studies

Case 1: Watergate Scandal (1972)

- **Conspiracy Type:** Government
- **Number of People Involved:** At least 69 individuals indicted, including the President and top aides.
- **Duration:** 2 years (1972-1974)
- **How Exposed:** Whistleblower "Deep Throat" (FBI Associate Director Mark Felt).

Case 2: My Lai Massacre Cover-Up (1968)

- **Conspiracy Type:** Military
- **Number of People Involved:** Approximately 30 soldiers and officers were aware or involved.
- **Duration:** 1 year (1968-1969)
- **How Exposed:** Whistleblower Ronald Ridenhour wrote letters to Congress and the Pentagon.

Case 3: Pentagon Papers (1971)

- **Conspiracy Type:** Government
- **Number of People Involved:** Over 1,000 analysts, policymakers, and military personnel contributed to classified studies.
- **Duration:** 3 years of secrecy following the Vietnam War study.
- **How Exposed:** Whistleblower Daniel Ellsberg leaked classified documents.

Case 4: NSA Surveillance (2013)

- **Conspiracy Type:** Government Intelligence
- **Number of People Involved:** Thousands of employees and contractors with security clearance.
- **Duration:** 6 years (2007-2013)
- **How Exposed:** Whistleblower Edward Snowden released classified information.

Hypothetical Analysis – Hitler's Survival Theory

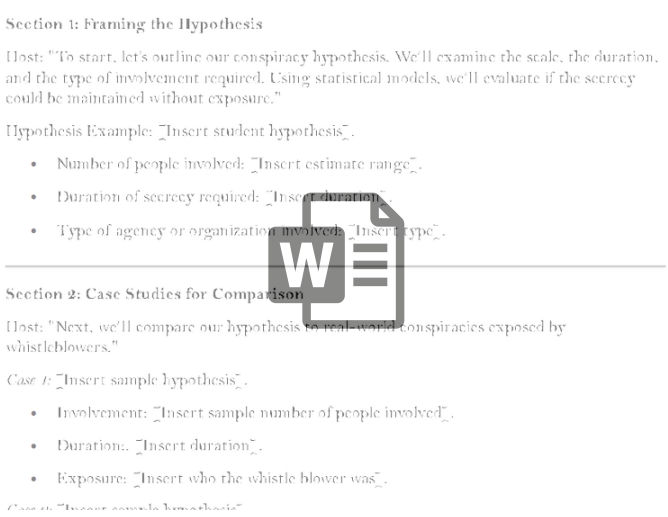
Scenario: Suppose Adolf Hitler survived World War II and fled to South America, living in secrecy until his death decades later.

Analysis:

1. **Number of People Required:**
   - **Minimum Estimate:** 20-30 (bodyguards, physicians, and confidants).
   - **Maximum Estimate:** 500+ (government officials, military, and intelligence personnel).
4. **Duration of Secrecy:** At least 50 years.
5. **Whistleblower Probability:** Using Dr. Robert Grimes' model, the probability of exposure increases exponentially with the number of people involved and time.
   - **Small Group Estimate (30 people):** 97% chance of exposure within 10 years.
   - **Large Group Estimate (500 people):** Near 100% chance of exposure within 10 years.
8. **Conclusion:** Maintaining secrecy for over 50 years would be statistically improbable based on historical patterns of whistleblowing.

Episode 7 Skeleton

Episode 7 Example



Section 1: Framing the Hypothesis

Host: "To start, let's outline our conspiracy hypothesis. We'll examine the scale, the duration, and the type of involvement required. Using statistical models, we'll evaluate if the secrecy could be maintained without exposure."

Hypothesis Example: ˜Insert student hypothesis˜.

- Number of people involved: ˜Insert estimate range˜.
- Duration of secrecy required: ˜Insert duration˜.
- Type of agency or organization involved: ˜Insert type˜.

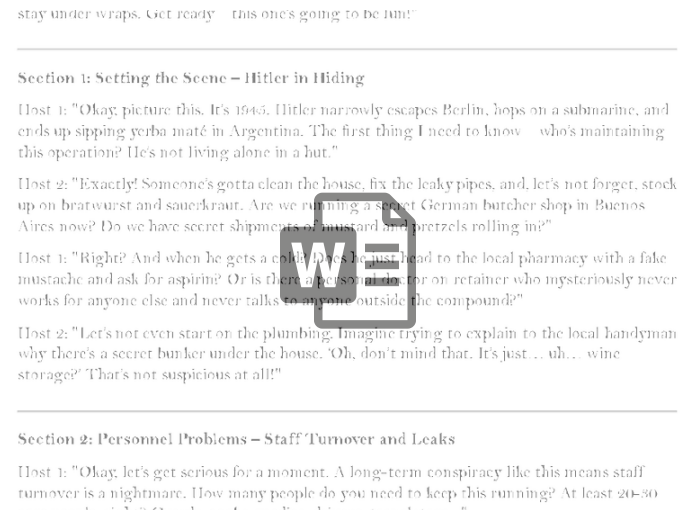
Section 2: Case Studies for Comparison

Host: "Next, we'll compare our hypothesis to real-world conspiracies exposed by whistleblowers."

Case 1: ˜Insert sample hypothesis˜.

- Involvement: ˜Insert sample number of people involved˜.
- Duration:. ˜Insert duration˜.
- Exposure: ˜Insert who the whistle blower was˜.

Case 2: ˜Insert sample hypothesis˜.



stay under wraps. Get ready — this one's going to be fun!"

Section 1: Setting the Scene – Hitler in Hiding

Host 1: "Okay, picture this. It's 1945. Hitler narrowly escapes Berlin, hops on a submarine, and ends up sipping yerba maté in Argentina. The first thing I need to know — who's maintaining this operation? He's not living alone in a hut."

Host 2: "Exactly! Someone's gotta clean the house, fix the leaky pipes, and, let's not forget, stock up on bratwurst and sauerkraut. Are we running a secret German butcher shop in Buenos Aires now? Do we have secret shipments of mustard and pretzels rolling in?"

Host 1: "Right? And when he gets a cold, does he just head to the local pharmacy with a fake mustache and ask for aspirin? Or is there a personal doctor on retainer who mysteriously never works for anyone else and never talks to anyone outside the compound?"

Host 2: "Let's not even start on the plumbing. Imagine trying to explain to the local handyman why there's a secret bunker under the house. 'Oh, don't mind that. It's just… uh… wine storage?' That's not suspicious at all!"

Section 2: Personnel Problems – Staff Turnover and Leaks

Host 1: "Okay, let's get serious for a moment. A long-term conspiracy like this means staff turnover is a nightmare. How many people do you need to keep this running? At least 20–30

- How does the number of people involved impact the chance of exposure?
- What patterns emerge when analyzing whistleblowers' actions?
- What lessons can we learn about secrecy and information control?